



Sony ZV-E1

Sony's new ZV-E1 priced at ₹2,14,990 packs a pretty feature-rich punch. Some, that even a consummate professional would drool over

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We rarely see a camera launch by Sony so special and confusing at the same time. We are talking about the (sort of) new Sony ZV-E1, a full frame, mirrorless, interchangeable lens camera with a whole slew of smart features and a super compact body. In fact, the ZV-E1 is Sony's smallest and lightest full-frame camera to date, beating out the A7C from about two years ago.

Build and Design - A power-packed petite

As you might expect with a flagship-level Sony camera, the build quality is top-notch. The materials used feel premium and the buttons have a bit less travel compared to other cameras from Sony like the A7S III from our studio. And while comparing the ZV-E1 with the A7S III, we also noticed how compact the ZV-E1 truly is. It is after all the most compact full-frame camera Sony has on the

market, but only up against the big boys do we realise the scale of it.

Not all of it is good though from a professional's point of view. For instance, the compact body obviously leaves little room for a ton of quality-of-life features such as more dials, customisable buttons etc. But what is really grinding my gears is that they could have somehow added a viewfinder as well to make it much more appealing to professionals. But in a bid to make it more "vlogger-friendly", this very useful feature has been dropped. And no, it's not like there isn't enough space to do so. The recently launched A7C II and A7C R both have viewfinders and are similar in size to the ZV-E1, AND have the same internals as well, including the 5-axis optical image stabilisation system and dual processors. Okay, rant over. Let's talk about what it does get.

First of all, it has very simple controls as most things can be controlled via the touch screen. On the top side, you get the on/off switch, shutter button and zoom slider all in one cluster. Along with that, you have a slider to switch

between the video/photo/S&Q modes. A dedicated big red recording button is also present and the C1 (Custom 1) button which by default is set as the Auto Background Defocus button. I will speak about this in detail later. There is also a dial that can be controlled with the thumb which will help you scroll fast if you want to make quick changes to the ISO, shutter speed, and aperture. Lastly, the top side also has a hot shoe mount on the left and the 3-capsule microphone grill in the middle.

The backside gets a few buttons as well. Definitely not many, but enough to simplify camera operations for a newbie. Starting from the top you get the C2 button, with the Fn button underneath it which can give you quick access to some of your settings. Underneath that, you have another dial with pressable buttons on the dials' North, South, East and West positions and another button right in the middle which acts as your main select button. And lastly, you have the Play button that shows the photos and videos you have just taken and the Delete button right next to it. The Menu button that gives you access to all your settings is right on the top, on a little ledge between the top side and the back side. The back side obviously also has the display which is of the twist and flip out type.

The left-hand side houses the your various input and output connections which include the single SD card slot in the middle, the external mic Audio input (3.5 mm jack) and USB C data and power port on the top. Then there's the mini HDMI output port and Audio monitoring (3.5 mm) audio output port, both towards the bottom. The bottom side has the hatch for the Z-type battery and the quarter inch screw mounting point.

Overall in in terms of the body and button placement, the camera ends up being pretty ergonomic but I did find the grip a bit too small and smooth. The ZV-E1 lacks the rough leathery texture that the more professional Sony cameras have for a nice tight grip and instead opts for a smoother indented rubber texture.